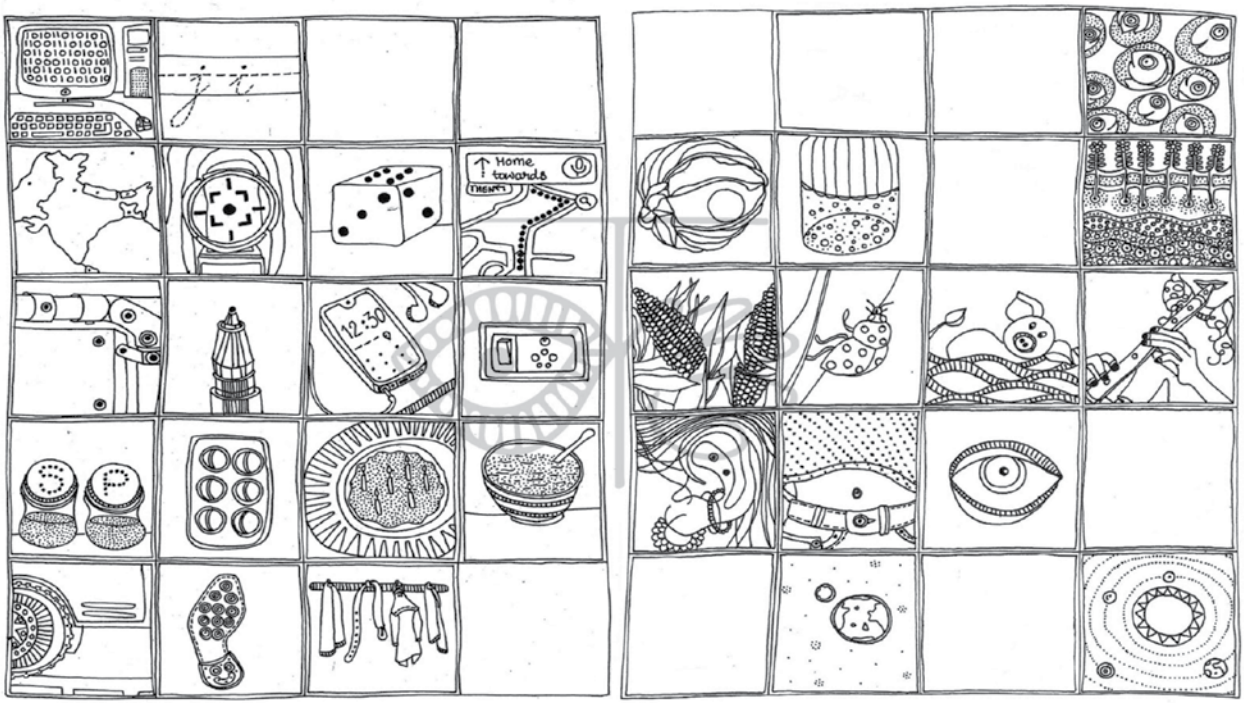
'Art'istic education

Siddhi Gupta

Kalakarm Curriculum is a resource/process/museum/collective that exists so that there is art in education and education in art. We make content and conduct workshops to discuss ways in which education can be made creative.

In our worksheet in this issue, we bring you ways in which art can be integrated with learning. We achieve this with the anchor of a DOT. Some educators may ask, "How?", especially when the DOT is not a part of the curriculum. We address this question with the very first activity in the series. (Each page can be coloured in!)

A Bingo ticket



What is art and what is not? The first step to art integration is identifying art. Like beauty, what is art depends on the seeker. One may see art in everything around them – and I ask why not? When we look at our textbooks and curricula, they are about this same world around us.

Activity

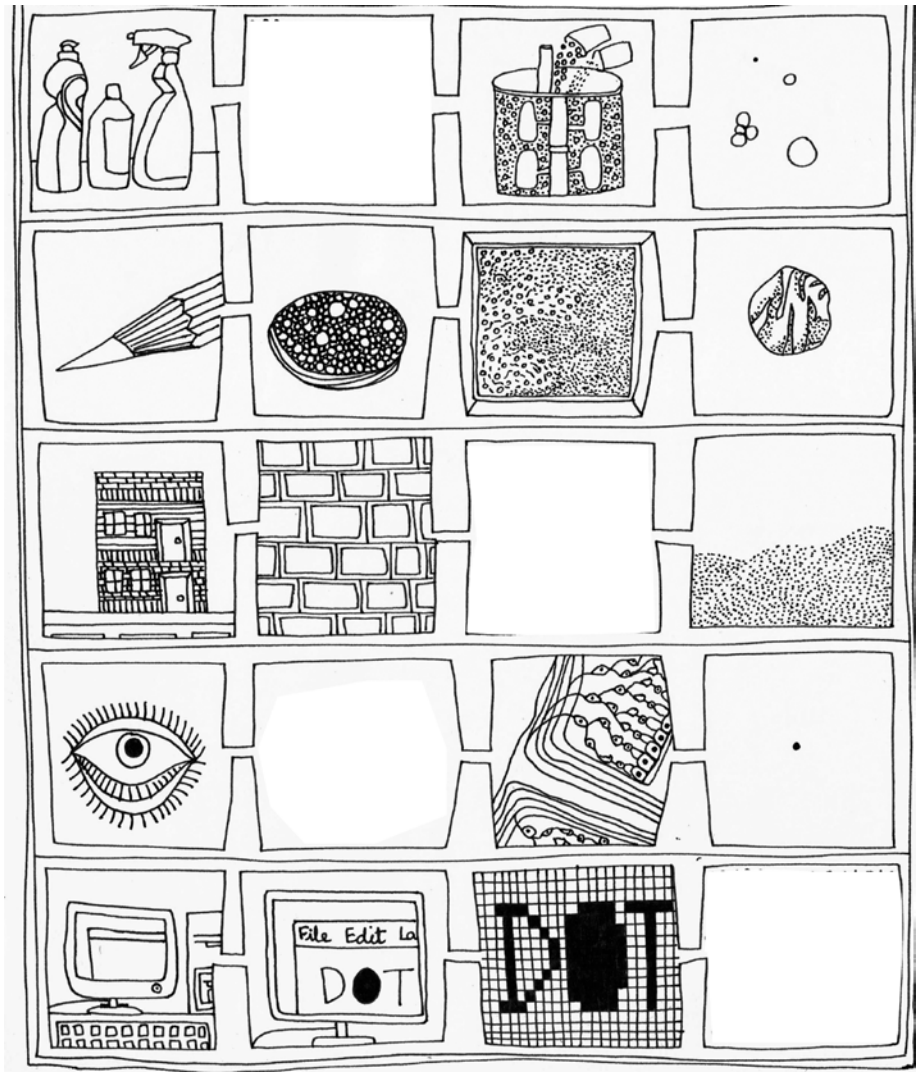
How many of the objects drawn on the bingo ticket are also present in your own environment? These are all objects with dots on them. The dot can be seen in objects, on your body, in the sky... as far as the space. In the empty boxes, can you depict other places from your environment where you could spot the dot?

This can be adapted for any concept that you are dealing with in your class. A bingo ticket allows us to notice the presence of art around us in our environment.

Fill in the blanks

You may have noticed the objects with dots on them around you, but when you think about it, isn't everything made of dots in some form or other? Isn't a seed, polymer, cell and grain of sand – a dot? Art Integration works best when it combines our environment with imagination and forces us to look at more than what simply meets the eye. In the following activity we look at a few objects around us and trace them down to their very basic unit – which in each case is some form of a dot.

Ask your students to fill in the empty boxes to complete the sequence.



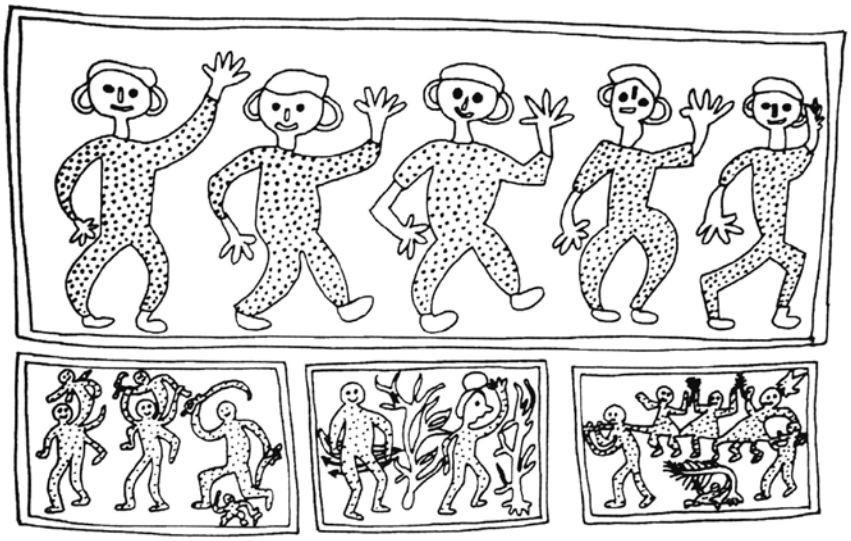
What they said

Activity
Let's read these quotes aloud and draw a response to them.

I'M JUST A DOT, BUT EVERY DOT IS A CIRCLE IN ITSELF, EVERY DOT IS THE END, EVERY DOT THE BEGINNING, EVERY DOT THE BEGINNING OF A WORD, OF A LETTER, OF AN ALPHABET, THE BEGINNING OF EVERY BEGINNING, THE BEGINNING OF NOTHING, OF EVERYTHING. THE BEGINNING OF A STROKE THAT ENDS IN A PAINTING, THE BEGINNING OF A NOTE THAT ENDS IN A SONG, AND EVERY CIRCLE IS THE COMING TOGETHER OF SEVERAL DOTS, WHERE EVERY DOT CAN THINK IT IS THE CIRCLE, AND THAT IT BEGAN THE CIRCLE AND GATHERED DOTS AROUND IT. –VENKAT RAMAN SINGH SHYAM

A LINE IS A DOT THAT WENT FOR A WALK.
–PAUL KLEE

Storytelling with Bhuri Bai



Bhuri Bai belongs to a community called Bhil; they make an artform that is known by the same name. You can see some of her paintings next to her. The artform is usually narrative where the artist tries to tell a story.

You can use the paintings and give different prompts corresponding to what you are teaching in class.

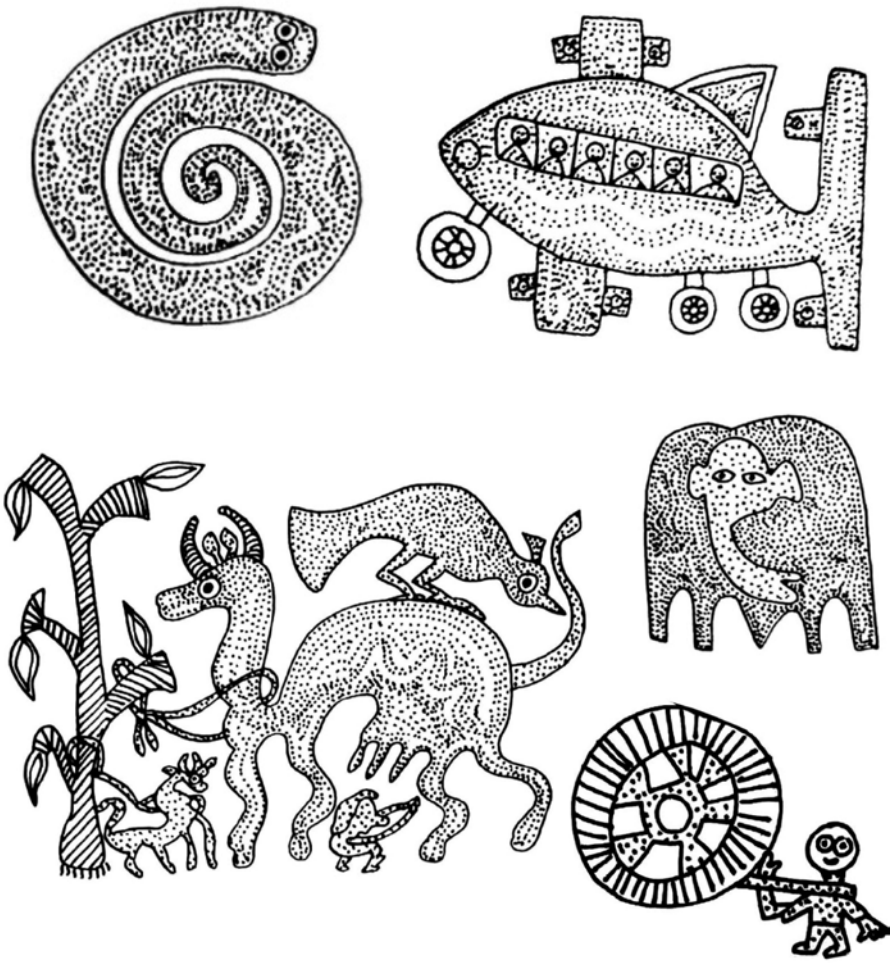
Activity

Fill in the blanks and make your own story. But you must use atleast two of the prompts given here. Draw the prompts you are using to write your story instead of writing them in words.

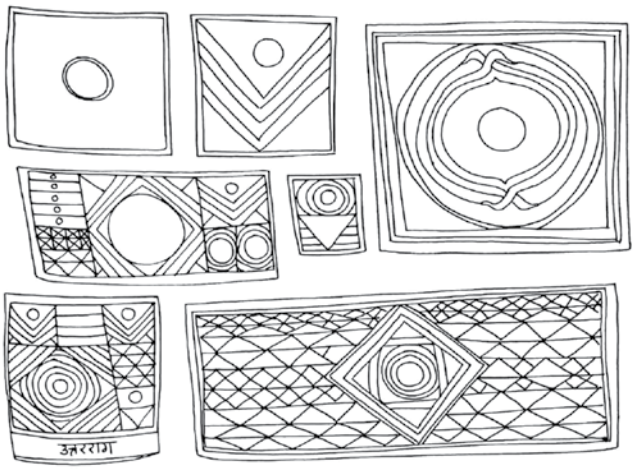
Example:

The ate corn and they appeared as dots all over his body .... or were they just the cells he was made of anyway?

..... **ate corn and** .....



Raza's Bindu

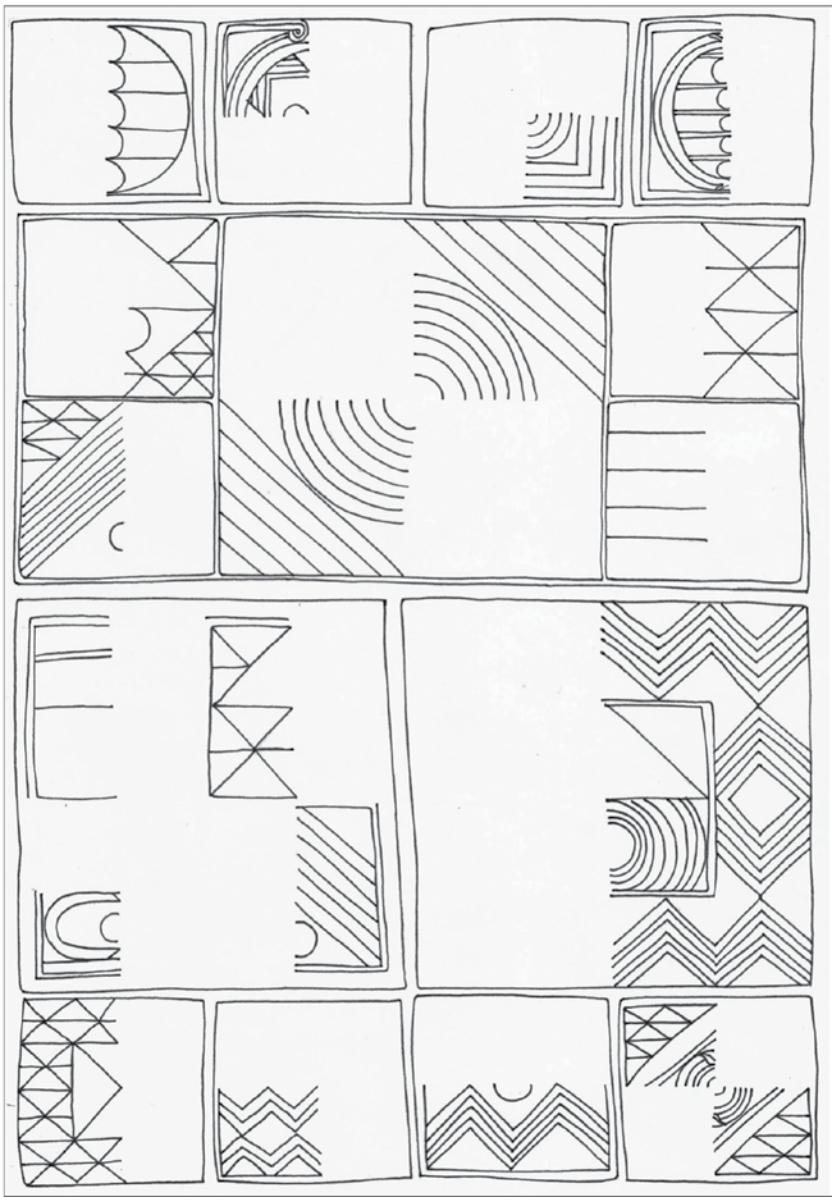


Raza's Bindu is a large body of work made by the artist over many years.

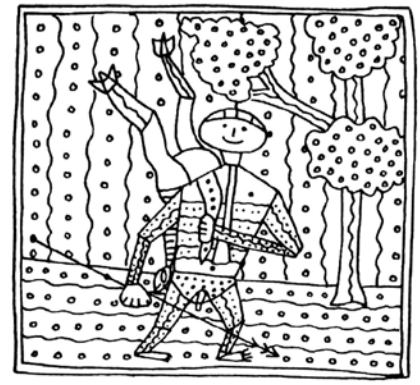
There is a lot that can be learnt from his paintings. They can be employed to learn concepts such as area and perimeter. Learners can also be asked to use geometry tools to recreate his paintings. Even though the artist himself didn't use these tools, it is worth asking learners about their experience.

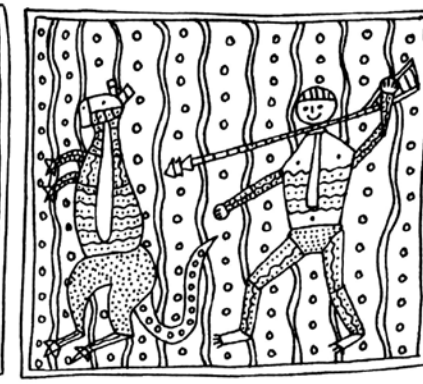
Activity

Complete the incomplete paintings using your imagination. You can rotate the worksheet any way you like. There is a direct connection to learning the principles of symmetry, but you don't need to complete the pattern; you can produce completely different drawings using these incomplete patterns.



Map your territory



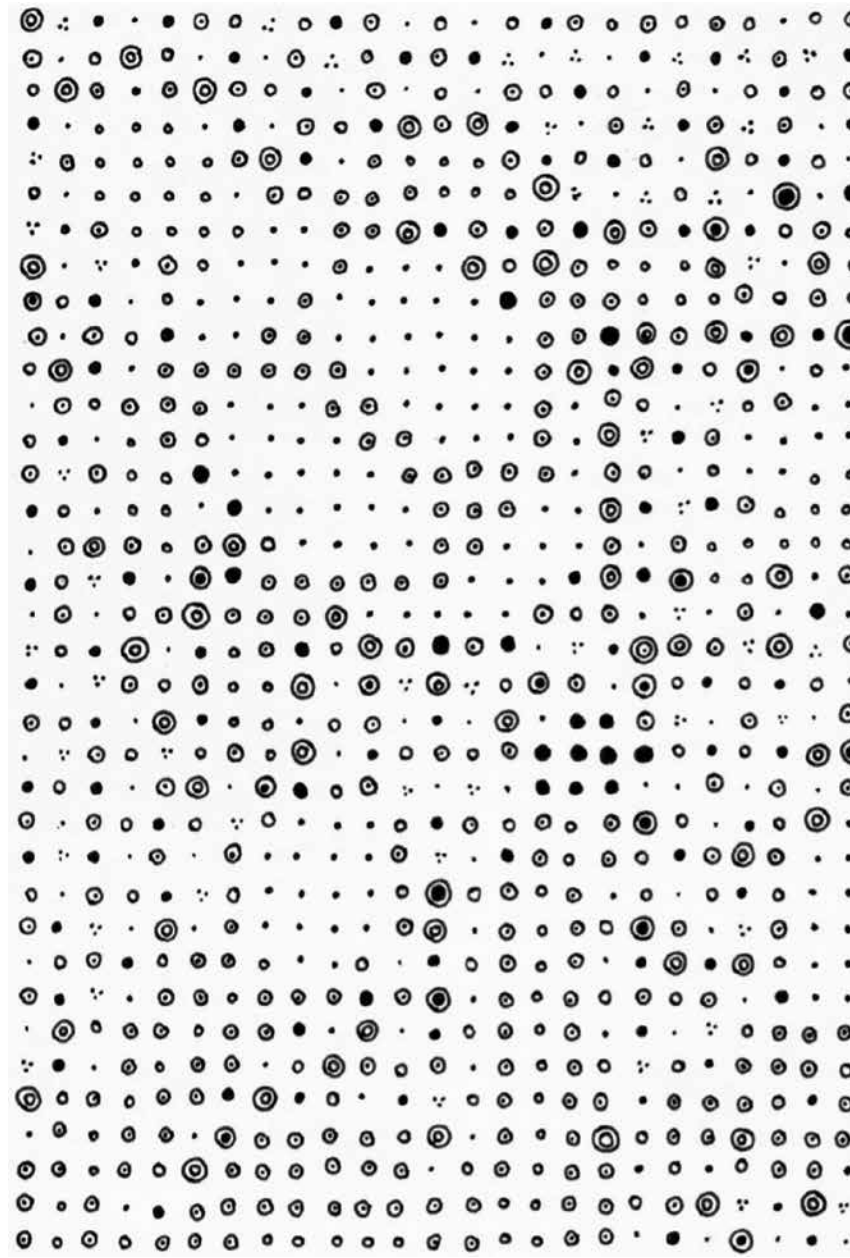


Robert Campbell Jr. was an Aboriginal artist who lived in Australia. His artform is widely documented and written about. There is an interesting element of mapping, where his paintings resemble actual landscapes from where the community resides.

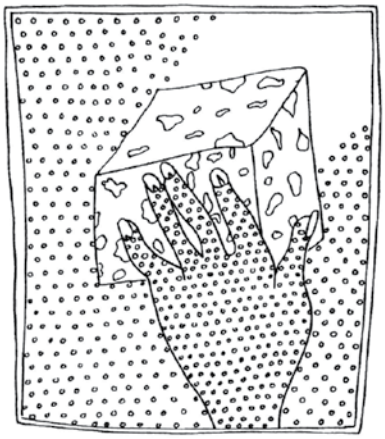
Geography is about understanding places, the activity can be adapted for exercises that involve maps or graphs in mathematics.

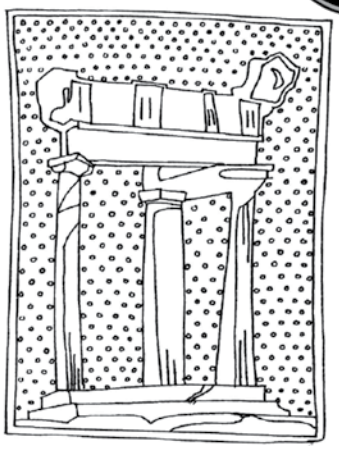
Activity

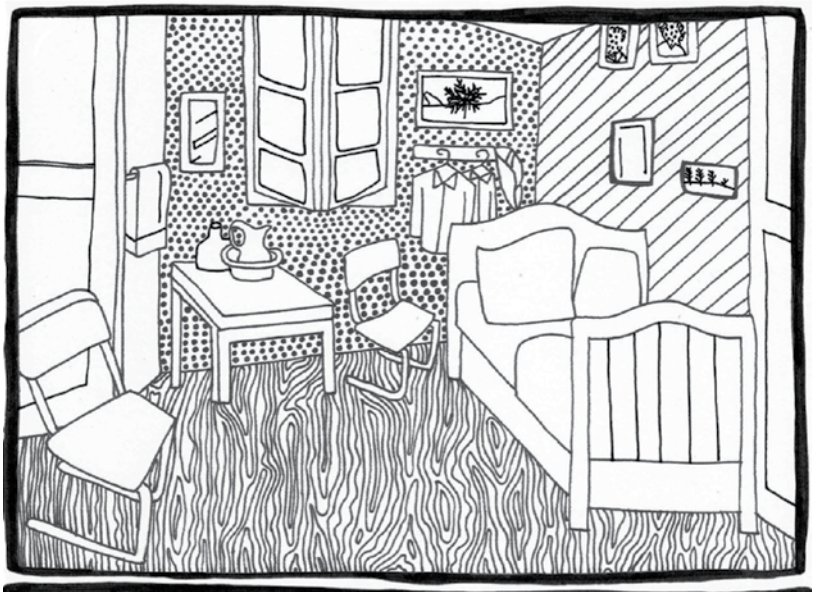
Circle dots that look the same. You can circle them horizontally, vertically or diagonally, but only dots that are four or more in number qualify to be encircled. Let's see if you can identify what these connected dots form.

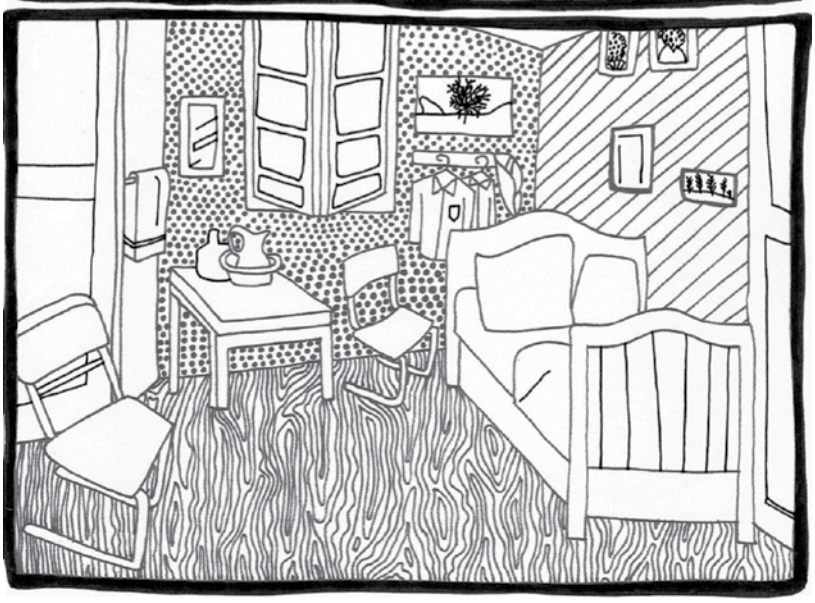


Spot the difference









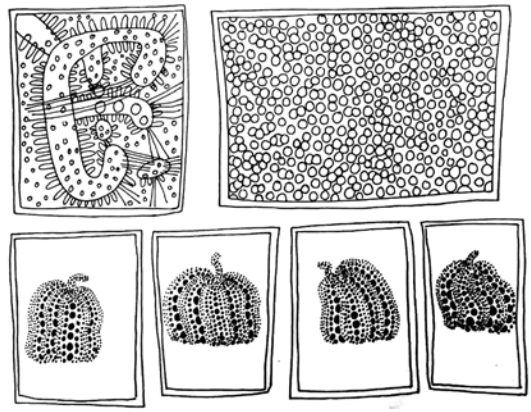
Roy Lichtenstien was an American artist, who was famous for his pop art paintings. This particular painting is his version of Van Gogh's painting of his own room.

Van Gogh made two versions of the painting. Roy was commissioned to make a 3D version of this painting. A couple have also recreated Van Gogh's version as a hotel room. You could find all these versions and try and spot the differences between them.

Paintings tell us about a particular time, place, people and culture. Some of them have many versions like this painting; you can spot the differences between these. You can also compare how the painting may be differently created by you, today, where you are.

Activity
Spot the differences.

Mindful making

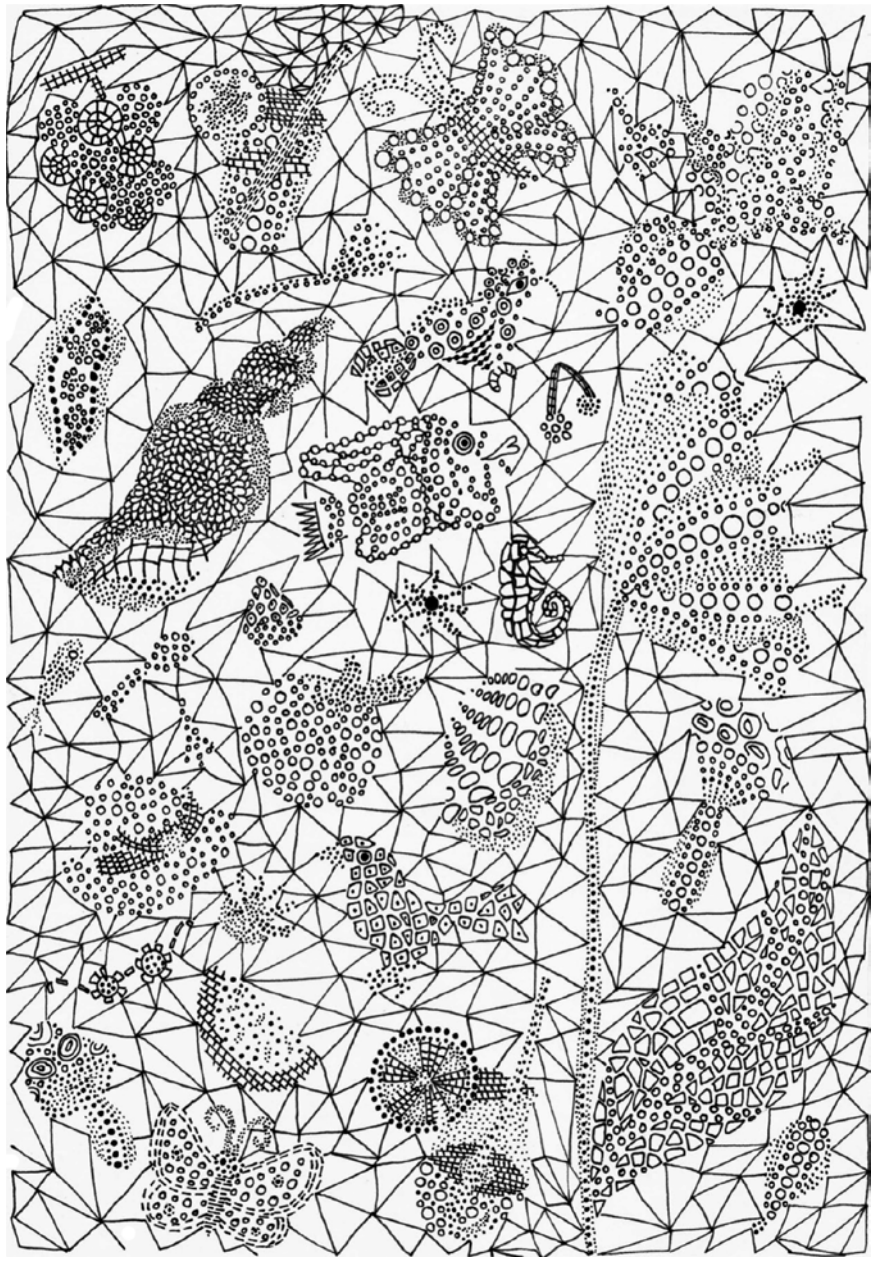


Yayoi Kusama is a Japanese artist making paintings with dots throughout her career.

Activity
Can you count the dots in the second painting in the first row?

How do you feel after doing the activity? What do you think the artist may have felt while making it?

Activity
There are many objects from Yayoi's paintings hidden in this pattern. Let's see how many you can find.



Note: Readers are requested to send in their worksheets after completion to Siddhi Gupta at her email id. She will add them to a visual gallery she is building on her website www.kalakarmcurriculum.org.

This worksheet has been developed by Siddhi Gupta. She is an illustrator working at the intersection of education, culture and communication. She is currently the hands and eyes at Kalakarm Curriculum and the Design and Communications Lead at Justice Adda. She can be reached at <kalakarmcurriculum@gmail.com>.